

Medicare Program; Final Rule — Home-Based & Palliative Services

Coverage (CY 2026)

42 CFR Part 410 · CMS-1234-F · Effective January 1, 2026 · Jurisdiction: Ohio (MAC JL/JM reference)

This final rule sets out coverage and payment determinations for home-based evaluation and management, advance care planning, remote physiologic monitoring, and telehealth services furnished to Medicare beneficiaries. Contractors shall apply the determinations below. (This is a synthetic document generated for platform testing.)

I. Coverage Determinations by Code

1. **99347** — Home visit, established patient, 15 minutes.
CPT 99347 (home visit, established patient, typically 15 minutes) is COVERED for Medicare beneficiaries in Ohio when medically necessary.
2. **99348** — Home visit, established patient, 25 minutes.
CPT 99348 (home visit, established patient, typically 25 minutes) is COVERED.
3. **99349** — Home visit, established patient, 40 minutes.
CPT 99349 (home visit, established patient, typically 40 minutes) is COVERED when the medical record documents medical necessity.
4. **99350** — Home visit, established patient, 60 minutes.
CPT 99350 (home visit, established patient, typically 60 minutes) is COVERED.
5. **99497** — Advance care planning, first 30 minutes.
CPT 99497 (advance care planning, first 30 minutes) is COVERED; the record must document that the discussion was voluntary and note the beneficiary or surrogate present.
6. **99498** — Advance care planning, each additional 30 minutes.
CPT 99498 (advance care planning, each additional 30 minutes) is COVERED only as an add-on reported with 99497.
7. **99453** — Remote physiologic monitoring set-up & education.
CPT 99453 (remote physiologic monitoring set-up and patient education) is NOT COVERED under the home-health consolidated billing benefit for these beneficiaries.
8. **99454** — RPM device supply, 30 days.
CPT 99454 (RPM device supply with daily recordings, each 30 days) is COVERED but is limited to one unit per 30-day period and requires at least 16 days of transmitted data.
9. **99457** — RPM treatment management, first 20 minutes.
CPT 99457 (remote physiologic monitoring treatment management services, first 20 minutes) is COVERED but REQUIRES PRIOR AUTHORIZATION.
10. **98016** — Brief virtual check-in.
HCPCS 98016 (brief communication technology-based service / virtual check-in) is reimbursed via telehealth at payment parity when billed with modifier 95.
11. **99251** — Inpatient consultation, straightforward.
CPT 99251 (inpatient consultation) is NOT COVERED; Medicare does not recognize consultation codes and payment will be denied.
12. **G0179** — Home health recertification.
HCPCS G0179 (physician recertification for Medicare-covered home health services) is COVERED once per 60-day episode.

II. Summary Table

Code	Description	Determination
99347	Home visit, established patient, 15 minutes	covered
99348	Home visit, established patient, 25 minutes	covered
99349	Home visit, established patient, 40 minutes	covered
99350	Home visit, established patient, 60 minutes	covered
99497	Advance care planning, first 30 minutes	covered (documentation required)
99498	Advance care planning, each additional 30 minutes	covered (add-on with 99497)
99453	Remote physiologic monitoring set-up & education	not_covered
99454	RPM device supply, 30 days	covered (frequency limit: 1 per 30 days, 16 days data)
99457	RPM treatment management, first 20 minutes	covered (prior authorization required)
98016	Brief virtual check-in	covered / telehealth (modifier 95)
99251	Inpatient consultation, straightforward	not_covered
G0179	Home health recertification	covered (1 per 60-day episode)

III. Documentation & Billing Notes

Advance care planning (99497/99498) requires documentation that the discussion was voluntary. Remote physiologic monitoring management (99457) requires prior authorization before the first management service is billed. Telehealth-eligible services must append modifier 95 for synchronous audio-video encounters. Consultation codes (99251–99255) are not payable under Medicare.